

Art and Architecture from Zero - The Foundation Track

Chapter F5.5 — From Zero: The Three Temple Styles, the Rock-Cut Caves,
Temple Architecture by Dynasty, Sculpture and the Mural Tradition

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NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

The cheapest marks in Module 5, and the chapter where the recognition-not-recall principle of F5.1 reaches its limit. Art questions are almost never analytical: they pair a monument with a dynasty, a style with a feature, or a material with a school. This chapter teaches the vocabulary first, because every question is phrased in it, then the three temple styles as a single comparison, then the rock-cut caves, then temple architecture dynasty by dynasty from the Guptas through the Cholas, Hoysalas, Chandelas and Vijayanagara, and finally sculpture, the Chola bronzes and the mural tradition from Ajanta to Lepakshi. It closes on the UNESCO cultural sites as a recognition list. Three chapters have already prepared the ground - stupa, chaitya and vihara from F5.3, the three sculpture schools by material and the Nagara beginnings from F5.4 - so a good deal of this chapter is consolidation rather than new learning. Study time 3 hours 30 minutes.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. Datings of individual temples follow the conventional attributions in standard reference works; several are disputed within a few decades and a few by more. Cave numbering at Ajanta and Ellora is the Archaeological Survey's and is a modern convenience, not a chronological order. Where the religious affiliation of a monument is contested, the standard attribution is given. Indo-Islamic architecture is deliberately NOT covered here: it belongs with the political history that produced it and is taken in F5.7.

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0. Why This Is the Cheapest Chapter in the Module

Nine of the ten history questions in 2023 were ancient, medieval or cultural. This is the cultural half, and it is pure recognition.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHY ART AND ARCHITECTURE REPAYS STUDY OUT OF ALL PROPORTION TO ITS DIFFICULTY

F5.1 established the module's governing principle: **the paper tests recognition, not recall, so one careful exposure to a wide field beats five to a narrow one. Art and architecture is where that principle pays best, for three reasons.**

- 1 The questions are almost never analytical.** They pair a **monument with a dynasty**, a **style with a feature**, or a **material with a school**. There is no reasoning step to get wrong
- 2 The vocabulary is finite and it is the question.** Perhaps twenty-five terms - shikhara, vimana, gopuram, garbhagriha, mandapa and so on - and once you hold them, the questions become self-answering, because **a question about a gopuram has already told you the answer is a southern temple**
- 3 It is heavily front-loaded onto a small number of famous sites.** Ajanta, Ellora, Khajuraho, Konark, Thanjavur, Mahabalipuram, Hampi. **Perhaps fifteen monuments carry nearly all the marks**

And the user-specific reason it matters here. You told me history is one of your three weak subjects. **This chapter is the part of history that behaves least like history** - it is closer to learning a parts catalogue, which is exactly the kind of material an engineer holds easily. **Do not treat it as the hard part of a hard module. Treat it as the module's bank.**

PYQ CONNECTION · THE EVIDENCE, AND WHAT IT SAYS ABOUT WEIGHTING

The verified 2023 paper gave history **10 questions**, of which **nine were ancient, medieval or art-and-culture**. That distribution was the basis for the settled decision in this project that **art and architecture receives FULL weight in Module 5 rather than being treated as a decorative appendix.**

Two further observations from the paper that shape this chapter:

- 1 The questions were recognition and matching, so partial knowledge scored.** A candidate who knew that Konark is a Sun Temple in Odisha but could not name its builder still answered a matching question correctly. **This is why breadth beats depth here more than anywhere else in the manual**
- 2 Nothing required a date.** Not one art question turned on a year. **So learn the DYNASTY, not the date** - "Chola" is a sufficient answer where "1010 CE" is not required

How much of this chapter is already yours. F5.3 gave you **stupa, chaitya and vihara** with their parts and sites. F5.4 gave you the **three sculpture schools separated by material, Bharhut and Sanchi placed under the Sungas**, and the **Nagara style beginning under the Guptas with Deogarh and Bhitargaon**. **That is a substantial fraction of the chapter already placed**, which is why its study time is the shortest in the module so far.

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F5.5 - THE FOUR SESSIONS

- 1 **Session 1 - The vocabulary and the three styles:** the parts of a temple, then Nagara, Dravida and Vesara as one comparison (Section 1)
 - 2 **Session 2 - Rock-cut architecture:** Barabar to Ajanta, Ellora, Elephanta, Karle and Mahabalipuram (Section 2)
 - 3 **Session 3 - Temple architecture by dynasty:** Gupta, Chalukya, Pallava, Chola, Hoysala, Odisha, Chandela, Solanki and Vijayanagara (Section 3)
 - 4 **Session 4 - Sculpture, bronzes and painting:** the schools consolidated, the Chola bronzes, the mural tradition, and the UNESCO list (Section 4)
- Then **42 graded questions**.

1. Session 1 - The Vocabulary and the Three Styles



Learn the parts before the buildings. Every question in this chapter is phrased in this vocabulary, and most are answered by it.

JARGON DECODER · THE PARTS OF A TEMPLE - THE TWELVE TERMS THAT ARE THE QUESTIONS

Learn these first and the rest of the chapter reads itself. A temple is a shrine with a tower over it and a hall in front, and every term below names one of those pieces.

- 1 **Garbhagriha** - literally "womb-chamber": the small, dark, innermost sanctum housing the principal image. **Every Hindu temple has one, and it is where the temple begins historically** - the earliest temples are little more than a garbhagriha with a porch
- 2 **Shikhara** - the tower over the garbhagriha. **In NORTHERN usage it means the whole curving spire; in SOUTHERN usage it means only the crowning element at the very top.** This double meaning is a genuine trap and is dealt with below
- 3 **Vimana** - the **southern** term for the pyramidal tower over the sanctum, built in receding storeys
- 4 **Mandapa** - the pillared hall in front of the sanctum, for the assembly of worshippers. Large temples have several in a row, sometimes named **ardha-mandapa, maha-mandapa, nata-mandapa** (for dance)
- 5 **Antarala** - the small vestibule connecting the mandapa to the garbhagriha
- 6 **Pradakshina patha** - the circumambulatory passage around the sanctum, for walking clockwise round the deity
- 7 **Amalaka** - the flat, fluted, melon-shaped stone disc near the top of a **northern** shikhara
- 8 **Kalasha** - the pot-shaped finial crowning the very top, above the amalaka
- 9 **Gopuram** - the **monumental gateway tower** in the enclosure wall of a **southern** temple. **The single most useful term in this chapter, because its presence identifies the style instantly**
- 10 **Jagati** - the raised platform or plinth on which a temple stands
- 11 **Panchayatana** - a temple plan with a **main shrine surrounded by four subsidiary shrines** at the corners of the plinth, making five in all
- 12 **Rathas** - in a temple context, the vertical projections or offsets of the wall and tower; **at Mahabalipuram, however, "rathas" means the monolithic shrines themselves**, which is a separate and more famous use

COMMON UPSC TRAP · THE SHIKHARA-VIMANA CONFUSION, AND HOW TO SETTLE IT

This is the vocabulary trap in the chapter, and it catches candidates because both traditions use the word "shikhara" for different things.

- 1 In the **NORTH (Nagara)**, **shikhara** is the **entire curvilinear tower** rising over the sanctum, topped by the **amalaka** and then the **kalasha**
- 2 In the **SOUTH (Dravida)**, the tower over the sanctum is the **VIMANA**, built as a series of **receding storeys** in a pyramid; and the word **shikhara** is reserved for the **small crowning dome or cupola at its apex** alone

So the safe formulations are: *the northern tower is a shikhara; the southern tower is a vimana whose topmost element is called a shikhara.* And if an option pairs **vimana** with a northern temple, or describes a **curvilinear** southern tower, it is wrong.

One more pairing to fix now, because it is asked in exactly this form: **amalaka and kalasha are NORTHERN features. Gopuram, vimana, and a large temple tank are SOUTHERN features.** Six words, and between them they answer a whole family of style-identification questions.

1.1 The three styles - the comparison that carries the session

Indian temple architecture is conventionally divided into three styles. The division is a scholarly convention rather than a rule the builders followed, but **the paper uses it, so learn it as given.**

Feature	NAGARA (northern)	DRAVIDA (southern)	VESARA (hybrid)
Region	North India, from the Himalaya to the Deccan plateau	Tamil Nadu and the far south	The Deccan, between the two
Tower over sanctum	Shikhara - curvilinear , rising in a continuous curve	Vimana - pyramidal , in receding storeys	Vimana of moderate height , with a shorter, stockier tower
Crowning element	Amalaka then kalasha	A small shikhara or stupika dome	Mixed, tending southern
Boundary and gateway	Usually no enclosure wall and NO gopuram	Enclosure walls with monumental GOPURAMS , which in later temples grow taller than the vimana itself	Enclosure present, gateways modest
Water	Usually no temple tank	A large tank is normal	Variable
Other markers	Often built on a jagati platform; panchayatana plans common	Nandi bull facing the shrine in Shaiva temples; pillared corridors and halls of many pillars	Emphasis on sculptural decoration over height
Chief patrons	Guptas, then Chandelas, Eastern Gangas, Solankis, Pratiharas	Pallavas, then Cholas , Pandyas, Nayakas, Vijayanagara	Chalukyas of Badami and Kalyani, Hoysalas

Nagara, Dravida and Vesara compared - the identification table

HIGH YIELD · THE THREE NAGARA SUB-SCHOOLS, AND THE ONE-LINE IDENTIFIER FOR EACH

Nagara is not uniform, and the paper does distinguish its regional schools. **Three, and each has a single reliable identifier.**

- 1 **ODISHA / KALINGA school** - the tower is called a **deul** (specifically **rekha-deul**), and the hall in front is the **jagamohan**. **The deul is nearly vertical for most of its height and then curves in sharply at the top**, which is the visual signature. **Lingaraja at Bhubaneswar, Jagannath at Puri, Konark**
- 2 **CENTRAL INDIA / KHAJURAHO school (Chandelas)** - **many shikharas clustered around and rising towards the main one**, so the whole temple reads as a mountain range rather than a single peak; built on a **high jagati**, with **no enclosure wall**, and **profuse sculpture on the exterior**. **Kandariya Mahadeva**
- 3 **SOLANKI / MARU-GURJARA school (Gujarat and Rajasthan)** - **the interiors are the achievement**: extraordinarily intricate carving of ceilings and pillars, and **stepwells and temple tanks are a speciality**. **Modhera Sun Temple, Rani ki Vav, and the Dilwara Jain temples of F5.3**

The Odisha vocabulary is worth special attention - **deul** and **jagamohan** appear in questions verbatim, and a candidate who does not know them cannot answer even a recognition question about Bhubaneswar or Konark.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

- 1 Define garbhagriha, mandapa, antarala and pradakshina patha
- 2 State both meanings of shikhara, and say what a vimana is
- 3 Which of amalaka, kalasha, gopuram and temple tank are northern and which southern?
- 4 What is a panchayatana plan, and what is a jagati?
- 5 Give the two meanings of "ratha" in an architectural question
- 6 Compare Nagara and Dravida on tower shape, crowning element, gateway and water
- 7 What is Vesara, and which two dynasties are its chief patrons?
- 8 Name the three Nagara sub-schools with the identifier of each
- 9 What are a deul and a jagamohan, and which school uses those words?

2. Session 2 - Rock-Cut Architecture ★★★★★

Not built but excavated - carved downward and inward out of living rock, which is why the biggest of them has no foundation and no joints.

START FROM ZERO · WHAT ROCK-CUT MEANS, AND WHY IT IS TECHNICALLY REMARKABLE

A rock-cut monument is not constructed; it is subtracted. Masons began at the top of a cliff or boulder and **cut away everything that was not the building**, working downward and inward. There are **no foundations, no walls built up course by course, and no joints** - the pillars, roof, sculpture and shrine are all one continuous piece of the parent rock.

Two consequences worth understanding, because they explain the questions:

- 1 There is no room for error.** Built architecture allows a wrong stone to be replaced; **subtractive work cannot put rock back.** The whole design had to be resolved before the first cut
- 2 The forms imitate carpentry.** The earliest chaitya halls have **stone "beams" and "rafters" carved into the ceiling** that carry no load at all, because the builders were reproducing the timber buildings they knew. **That imitation is a reliable dating indicator - the more wooden-looking, the earlier**

The historical sequence to hold: Mauryan Barabar caves, then the Buddhist chaityas and viharas of the western Deccan under the Satavahanas, then Ajanta's painted phase, then the great multi-faith complex at Ellora, and finally the Pallava work at Mahabalipuram which transitions from rock-cut to structural building.

2.1 The cave sites - name, faith, and the one thing each is known for

Site	Where and whose	What it is known for
Barabar caves	Bihar; Mauryan	The EARLIEST rock-cut caves in India , of Ashoka's time, and associated with the Ajivikas of F5.3. The Lomas Rishi cave's doorway imitates a wooden facade - the carpentry imitation in its purest form
Karle	Maharashtra; Buddhist , Satavahana period	The largest and finest CHAITYA hall in India , with a great horseshoe window, a stupa at the apsidal end, and pillars with animal capitals. If a question asks for the greatest chaitya, the answer is Karle
Bhaja, Bedsa, Kanheri, Nasik	Maharashtra; Buddhist	Early chaitya and vihara groups of the western Deccan. Recognise the names; do not study them individually
Ajanta	Maharashtra; BUDDHIST ONLY	About 29 to 30 caves , both chaityas and viharas , cut in a horseshoe gorge. Famous above all for its PAINTINGS , the finest surviving ancient Indian murals. Patronised under the Satavahanas and then the Vakatakas in the Gupta age . UNESCO World Heritage Site. The single most important point: Ajanta is entirely Buddhist
Ellora	Maharashtra; THREE FAITHS	34 caves - 12 BUDDHIST, 17 HINDU, 5 JAIN , worked under the Rashtrakutas and their predecessors. Cave 16 is the KAILASA temple , a complete temple carved from a single rock from the top downward , attributed to the Rashtrakuta Krishna I - the greatest monolithic excavation anywhere. Jain caves 30-34 include the Indra Sabha . UNESCO. The three-faith composition is itself the standard question
Elephanta	Island near Mumbai; Shaiva	Famous for the Trimurti or Maheshmurti - a colossal three-headed Shiva. UNESCO
Udayagiri and Khandagiri	Odisha; JAIN	The Jain caves of F5.3, with Kharavela's Hathigumpha inscription
Badami caves	Karnataka; Chalukya	Rock-cut cave temples, Hindu and Jain, of the Chalukyas of Badami - the same dynasty that builds structurally at Aihole and Pattadakal

Site	Where and whose	What it is known for
Mahabalipuram	Tamil Nadu; Pallava	Four things: the monolithic RATHAS (called the Pancha Pandava rathas), the structural SHORE TEMPLE , the great open-air relief usually called the Descent of the Ganges or Arjuna's Penance , and rock-cut mandapas . UNESCO . It is the site where Indian architecture moves from cut to built

The rock-cut sites: the pairings to learn

COMMON UPSC TRAP · THE FOUR CAVE-SITE CONFUSIONS THAT DECIDE QUESTIONS

- 1 **AJANTA is Buddhist ONLY. ELLORA is Buddhist, Hindu AND Jain.** This is the most frequently asked distinction in the whole chapter. **Ajanta = paintings; Ellora = the Kailasa temple**
- 2 **The KAILASA temple is at ELLORA, not Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram.** Two different monuments with confusingly similar names: **Kailasa at Ellora is Rashtrakuta and monolithic; Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram is PALLAVA and structural**
- 3 **The TRIMURTI is at ELEPHANTA, not Ellora.** The names are similar and the options exploit it
- 4 **The BARABAR caves are the earliest, and they are Mauryan and Ajivika-associated - not Buddhist,** which is what candidates assume of any early cave

One further pairing worth fixing: the "rathas" at Mahabalipuram are monolithic SHRINES, not chariots and not wall projections. The Shore Temple at the same site is **structural**, i.e. built of cut stone blocks - so **Mahabalipuram contains both techniques**, which is exactly why it matters.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

- 1 Explain what rock-cut means, and why there is no margin for error
- 2 What is the carpentry imitation, and how does it help with dating?
- 3 Which are the earliest rock-cut caves, whose reign, and with which sect associated?
- 4 Where is the finest chaitya hall in India?
- 5 How many caves at Ajanta, of what faith, and what is it most famous for?
- 6 Give Ellora's cave count and its split by faith
- 7 What is Ellora cave 16, who built it, and how was it made?
- 8 Where is the Trimurti, and where is the Kailasa temple?
- 9 Name the four things Mahabalipuram is known for
- 10 Why does Mahabalipuram mark a transition?

3. Session 3 - Temple Architecture by Dynasty



The paper asks monument-to-dynasty. So learn it that way round, and learn the dynasty rather than the date.

START FROM ZERO · THE FOUR STAGES A TEMPLE PASSES THROUGH, WHICH IS WHY THE CHAPTER HAS A SHAPE

Indian temple architecture develops along one clear line, and knowing it turns a list of monuments into a sequence.

- 1 **Stage 1 - a flat-roofed shrine.** A single cubical **garbhagriha** with a shallow pillared porch and **no tower**. **Gupta period: Sanchi temple 17**
- 2 **Stage 2 - a shrine with a tower.** The same cell, now with a **shikhara** over it, and the plan beginning to grow. **Gupta: Dashavatara at Deogarh**
- 3 **Stage 3 - the developed temple.** A sequence of **mandapas** leading to the sanctum, a tall tower, a **jagati** platform, and sculpture over the whole exterior. **Khajuraho, Lingaraja, Brihadeeswara**
- 4 **Stage 4 - the temple as a walled town.** Enclosure after enclosure, each with **gopurams growing taller than the vimana**, plus tanks, corridors, halls of a thousand pillars and subsidiary shrines. **Vijayanagara and Nayaka: Hampi, Madurai**

The single trend to hold, and it answers "how did southern temples change over time": the tower stopped being the tallest thing. In a Chola temple the **vimana dominates**; by the Nayaka period the **gopuram dominates** and the vimana is comparatively small. That inversion is the clearest development in southern architecture and it is examinable.

3.1 The dynastic table - the core of the chapter

Dynasty	Style	Monuments, and what each is known for
Gupta	Nagara , at its beginning	Dashavatara temple, DEOGARH - the classic early Nagara shrine with a shikhara. BHITARGAON - the major early BRICK temple. Sanchi temple 17 - flat-roofed, the earliest stage. Udayagiri caves , Vidisha
Chalukya of Badami	Vesara , and experimental	AIHOLE - called the cradle of Indian temple architecture because it contains experiments in all styles side by side; the Durga temple with its apsidal plan and the flat-roofed Lad Khan . PATTADAKAL - UNESCO , where northern and southern forms stand together, the Virupaksha temple being the chief southern-style example. BADAMI cave temples
Pallava	Dravida , in four stages	MAHABALIPURAM - the monolithic rathas and the structural SHORE TEMPLE . KAILASANATHA temple, KANCHIPURAM - the great structural Pallava temple, under Rajasimha . Also Vaikuntha Perumal , Kanchipuram. The Pallavas are where Dravida architecture is invented
Chola	Dravida , at its height	BRIHADEESWARA (Rajarajeswara) temple, THANJAVUR - built by RAJARAJA I , about 1010 CE , with a vimana of roughly sixty metres and a massive monolithic capstone and Nandi . GANGAIKONDACHOLAPURAM by Rajendra I . AIRAVATESVARA at Darasuram by Rajaraja II . These three are the UNESCO "Great Living Chola Temples" . In Chola work the vimana dominates and the gopurams are modest - the reverse of later practice
Hoysala	Vesara , at its most ornamented	BELUR (Chennakesava), HALEBIDU (Hoysaleswara) and SOMNATHPUR . Built in soft soapstone / chlorite schist , which permits carving of almost metallic fineness. STELLATE (star-shaped) plans on a raised jagati , with lathe-turned pillars and a low, broad tower. UNESCO, inscribed 2023 . Decoration over height is the Hoysala signature

Dynasty	Style	Monuments, and what each is known for
Eastern Ganga and predecessors (Odisha)	Nagara , Kalinga school	LINGARAJA, Bhubaneswar - the mature Odishan deul . JAGANNATH, Puri . KONARK Sun Temple by NARASIMHADEVA I of the Eastern Gangas - conceived as the sun god's chariot with twelve pairs of carved wheels and seven horses ; also called the Black Pagoda ; UNESCO . Also Mukteswara and Rajarani at Bhubaneswar
Chandela	Nagara , Khajuraho school	KHAJURAHO - UNESCO . KANDARIYA MAHADEVA is the largest and finest, with clustered shikharas rising to a central peak, a high jagati , no enclosure wall , and famously profuse exterior sculpture including erotic panels. Also Lakshmana and Vishvanatha
Solanki (Chaulukya)	Nagara , Maru-Gurjara school	MODHERA Sun Temple , Gujarat, with its stepped tank. RANI KI VAV at Patan - a stepwell , UNESCO 2014 , and the outstanding example of the type. The DILWARA Jain temples at Mount Abu from F5.3. Interiors and stepwells are this school's achievement
Vijayanagara	Dravida , stage 4	HAMPI - UNESCO . The Vittala temple with its stone chariot and musical pillars ; the Virupaksha temple. Innovations: the kalyana mandapa (marriage hall), the amman shrine for the goddess, huge pillared corridors, and gopurams becoming the dominant element
Nayaka	Dravida , stage 4 completed	MEENAKSHI temple, MADURAI - concentric enclosures, towering gopurams, and a hall of a thousand pillars . The gopuram now overwhelms the vimana entirely

Temple architecture by dynasty: the monument-to-dynasty pairings

HIGH YIELD · THE TEN PAIRINGS THAT CARRY THIS SESSION, IF YOU LEARN NOTHING ELSE

- 1 **Brihadeeswara, Thanjavur = CHOLA, Rajaraja I**
- 2 **Konark Sun Temple = EASTERN GANGA, Narasimhadeva I** - and it is a **chariot** with **twelve pairs of wheels and seven horses**
- 3 **Khajuraho = CHANDELA**, and **Kandariya Mahadeva** is its greatest temple
- 4 **Kailasa temple, Ellora = RASHTRAKUTA, Krishna I**, monolithic
- 5 **Mahabalipuram and Kailasanatha Kanchipuram = PALLAVA**
- 6 **Belur, Halebidu, Somnathpur = HOYSALA**, in **soapstone**, on **stellate** plans
- 7 **Aihole and Pattadakal = CHALUKYA of Badami**; **Aihole is the "cradle"**, **Pattadakal is UNESCO**
- 8 **Hampi and the Vittala stone chariot = VIJAYANAGARA**
- 9 **Meenakshi, Madurai = NAYAKA**, with gopurams dominant
- 10 **Rani ki Vav and Modhera = SOLANKI**, Gujarat

Two "greatest" answers worth separating, because both are asked and they are different questions. The **largest monolithic excavation** is the **Kailasa temple at Ellora**. The **greatest chaitya hall** is at **Karle**. The **tallest Chola vimana** is at **Thanjavur**. **Three superlatives, three different sites.**

4. Session 4 - Sculpture, Bronzes and the Mural Tradition ★★★★★

The buildings are the frame. The images inside them, and the paintings on their walls, are a separate set of questions.

KNOW · SCULPTURE CONSOLIDATED - THE SCHOOLS AND THE PERIODS

The three ancient schools were separated by **MATERIAL** in F5.4, and that remains the fastest route to an answer:

- 1 **GANDHARA** - grey schist, Greco-Roman influence, wavy hair and heavy drapery. Kushana, north-west. **Also called Greco-Buddhist**
- 2 **MATHURA** - spotted red sandstone from Sikri, indigenous conventions, shaven head and decorated halo. Kushana, and it produced **Jain and Brahmanical images as well as Buddhist**
- 3 **AMARAVATI** - white limestone, narrative panels crowded with slender figures. Satavahana and Ikshvaku, Andhra

Then the later phases, each with one identifier:

- 1 **GUPTA sculpture** - the classical synthesis: restrained, serene, with the **SARNATH BUDDHA** as its defining image and the **Sultanganj bronze Buddha** as its largest metal survival. **Gupta work is the model later Indian sculpture refers back to**
- 2 **PALA sculpture and bronzes** - eastern India, Bengal and Bihar, in **black basalt** and bronze, associated with **Nalanda** and Vajrayana Buddhism. **Exported stylistically to Nepal, Tibet and South-East Asia**
- 3 **Terracotta** - a continuous tradition from the Harappans onward, and the characteristic medium of **Bengal temple decoration** later

The one-line summary of the sculptural sequence, which is a fair interview answer: from the aniconic symbols of early Buddhism (F5.3), through the first images under the Kushanas in two competing styles, to the Gupta classical ideal that fixed the canon.

MUST MASTER · THE CHOLA BRONZES - THE HIGHEST ACHIEVEMENT OF INDIAN METAL SCULPTURE

Treated separately because they are asked separately, and because they are the one topic in this chapter where a technical process is examinable.

- 1 **The technique is LOST-WAX casting**, known as **cire perdue**. A model is made in **wax**, coated in clay to form a mould, the wax is **melted and drained out**, molten metal is poured into the void, and the mould is broken to release the finished piece. **Each casting therefore destroys its own mould, so every bronze is unique** - there are no duplicates by definition
- 2 **The metal** is bronze, an alloy of **copper with tin** - the same alloy as the Harappan Dancing Girl of F5.1, which was cast by the same lost-wax method **three thousand years earlier**. **That continuity is worth stating: the technique is one of the longest-lived in Indian technology**
- 3 **The subject that matters is NATARAJA**, Shiva as lord of the dance, in the **ananda tandava** posture within a ring of flame - **the single most recognised image in Indian art**, and the standard answer to any question on Chola bronzes
- 4 **Chief period and patrons**: the **Chola** dynasty, tenth to twelfth centuries, with **Thanjavur and Chidambaram** as centres. **Sembiyan Mahadevi and Rajaraja I's queens** were notable donors

As a Mechanical Engineer you should note what lost-wax actually achieves. It is an **investment casting** process, and it is the same principle used today for turbine blades and precision components - **a sacrificial pattern permitting undercuts and internal detail that no two-part mould could release**. The Chola founders were solving a mould-release problem, and they solved it the way a modern foundry does.

4.1 The mural tradition

Painting survives far less well than stone, so the tradition is known from a small number of sites - which makes it easy to learn.

Site	Period and faith	What to know
Bhimbetka	Prehistoric	The rock paintings of F5.1 - the beginning of the tradition, and UNESCO
AJANTA	Satavahana to Vakataka / Gupta; Buddhist	The finest ancient Indian painting. Technique is tempera on a prepared plaster ground - properly fresco-secco , applied to DRY plaster, not true fresco , and that distinction is asked. Famous individual works: Bodhisattva PADMAPANI and Vajrapani , the Mahajanaka Jataka , and the so-called Dying Princess . Subjects are Jataka stories, which F5.3 supplied
Bagh caves	Gupta period; Buddhist	Madhya Pradesh. Closely related to Ajanta in style , and the usual second name in a question about ancient murals
Sittanavasal	Pandya; JAIN	Tamil Nadu. The principal JAIN mural site , with its lotus-pond ceiling. The faith is the examinable part - it is the Jain counterpart to Buddhist Ajanta
Badami	Chalukya; Hindu	Among the earliest surviving Hindu murals
Ellora and Elephanta	Rashtrakuta and later	Painted plaster survives in patches, much decayed
Lepakshi	Vijayanagara; Hindu	Andhra Pradesh. The major late-medieval mural cycle , on temple ceilings
Tanjore / Brihadeeswara	Chola	Chola-period murals were found beneath later Nayaka overpainting in the Thanjavur temple passage - a good instance of one period literally covering another

The surviving mural sites

The one technical point that is asked: Ajanta is NOT true fresco. True fresco is painted onto **wet** plaster so that the pigment binds chemically as the lime sets. **Ajanta's painters worked on a DRY prepared surface with a binding medium - tempera, or fresco-secco.** An option describing Ajanta as true fresco is wrong, and it appears.

KNOW · THE UNESCO CULTURAL SITES AS A RECOGNITION LIST

Worth ten minutes, because UNESCO status is a standard way to frame an art question, and because it also serves General Knowledge. These are the ones from this chapter and its neighbours:

- 1 **Ajanta caves** and **Ellora caves**, Maharashtra
- 2 **Elephanta caves**, Maharashtra
- 3 **Group of Monuments at MAHABALIPURAM**, Tamil Nadu
- 4 **Great Living Chola Temples** - Thanjavur, Gangaikondacholapuram, Darasuram
- 5 **Group of Monuments at PATTADAKAL**, Karnataka
- 6 **Group of Monuments at HAMPI**, Karnataka
- 7 **Khajuraho Group of Monuments**, Madhya Pradesh
- 8 **Sun Temple, KONARK**, Odisha
- 9 **Buddhist Monuments at SANCHI**, Madhya Pradesh
- 10 **Mahabodhi Temple Complex, BODH GAYA**, Bihar
- 11 **Rock Shelters of BHIMBETKA**, Madhya Pradesh
- 12 **Rani ki Vav**, Patan, Gujarat
- 13 **Sacred Ensembles of the HOYSALAS** - Belur, Halebidu, Somnathpur
- 14 **DHOLAVIRA**, Gujarat - the Harappan city of F5.1

A pattern worth noticing rather than memorising: Maharashtra and Karnataka carry a disproportionate share, because rock-cut and Deccan temple architecture are both concentrated there. If a question asks which state has the most cave-architecture sites, **Maharashtra** is the answer.

ACTION · WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU, AND WHAT F5.6 DOES

Module 5's two highest-yield chapters are now done. **Between F5.3, F5.4 and this chapter you hold the whole of the art and architecture field:** the Buddhist forms and their symbols, the three sculpture schools by material, the three temple styles with their vocabulary, the rock-cut sites by faith, temple architecture dynasty by dynasty, the Chola bronzes, the mural sites and the UNESCO list.

Use the wall sheet hard on this one. It is the densest recognition sheet in the module, and it is the chapter where the day 1 / day 7 / day 30 schedule converts most directly into marks.

F5.6 takes the remaining cultural ground: the classical **texts and languages**, **ancient Indian science** beyond the Gupta names, and the **performing arts** - the classical dance forms with their states, the two systems of classical music, and the **miniature painting schools** (Mughal, Rajput, Pahari and Deccani), which were deliberately held back from this chapter because they belong with the courts that produced them. **After that F5.7 begins medieval India, where Indo-Islamic architecture is taken up with the politics that produced it.**

5. Graded Practice - 42 Questions ★★★★★

5.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. The garbhagriha of a temple is

(a) the innermost sanctum housing the principal image (b) the pillared hall (c) the gateway tower (d) the circumambulatory passage

Q. 2. The gopuram is characteristic of

(a) Nagara temples (b) Dravida temples (c) Vesara temples (d) Buddhist stupas

Q. 3. In northern temple architecture, the curvilinear tower over the sanctum is called the

(a) vimana (b) gopuram (c) shikhara (d) jagamohan

Q. 4. In southern temple architecture, the pyramidal tower over the sanctum is called the

(a) vimana (b) shikhara (c) amalaka (d) mandapa

Q. 5. The amalaka and kalasha are features of

(a) Dravida temples (b) Nagara temples (c) Buddhist chaityas (d) Jain stepwells

Q. 6. The earliest rock-cut caves in India are at

(a) Ajanta (b) Ellora (c) Barabar (d) Karle

Q. 7. The largest and finest chaitya hall in India is at

(a) Bhaja (b) Nasik (c) Kanheri (d) Karle

Q. 8. The Ajanta caves belong to

(a) Buddhism only (b) Buddhism and Hinduism (c) Hinduism and Jainism (d) three faiths

Q. 9. The number of caves at Ellora is

(a) 12 (b) 17 (c) 29 (d) 34

Q. 10. The Kailasa temple at Ellora is attributed to

(a) Rajaraja I of the Cholas (b) Krishna I of the Rashtrakutas (c) Rajasimha of the Pallavas (d) Narasimhadeva I

Q. 11. The Trimurti, or Maheshmurti, is at

(a) Ellora (b) Ajanta (c) Elephanta (d) Badami

Q. 12. The Brihadeeswara temple at Thanjavur was built by

(a) Rajendra I (b) Krishna I (c) Rajaraja II (d) Rajaraja I

Q. 13. The Sun Temple at Konark was built by

(a) Narasimhadeva I (b) Rajaraja I (c) Krishna I (d) Vishnuvardhana

Q. 14. The Khajuraho temples were built by the

(a) Solankis (b) Chandelas (c) Eastern Gangas (d) Hoysalas

Q. 15. Belur, Halebidu and Somnathpur belong to the

(a) Cholas (b) Pallavas (c) Hoysalas (d) Chalukyas of Badami

Q. 16. The famous Nataraja bronzes are associated with the

(a) Guptas (b) Pallavas (c) Palas (d) Cholas

5.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 17. The Vesara style is chiefly associated with the

(a) Chalukyas and Hoysalas (b) Cholas and Pandyas (c) Chandelas and Solankis (d) Pallavas and Rashtrakutas

Q. 18. Aihole is described as the cradle of Indian temple architecture because

(a) it is the oldest temple site in India (b) it contains experiments in several styles standing side by side (c) all Indian temples are copies of its plan (d) it is the largest temple complex in India

Q. 19. A panchayatana plan consists of

(a) five successive mandapas (b) five gopurams in a row (c) a main shrine with four subsidiary shrines at the corners of the plinth (d) a temple with five storeys

Q. 20. The caves at Ellora are divided by faith as

(a) all 34 Buddhist (b) 17 Buddhist, 12 Hindu, 5 Jain (c) 5 Buddhist, 12 Hindu, 17 Jain (d) 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu, 5 Jain

Q. 21. The Ajanta paintings were executed

(a) in tempera on a dry prepared plaster ground, that is fresco-secco (b) as true fresco, on wet plaster (c) in oil on wooden panels (d) as mosaic

Q. 22. The murals at Sittanavasal are

(a) Buddhist (b) Jain (c) Shaiva (d) Vaishnava

Q. 23. In lost-wax casting, or cire perdue,

(a) the same mould is reused many times (b) the metal is hammered over a wooden core (c) the wax model is melted out and the mould is broken to release the casting, so each piece is unique (d) the image is carved from stone and then plated

Q. 24. Hoysala temples are distinguished by

(a) grey schist and Greco-Roman influence (b) brick construction (c) tall gopurams dominating the vimana (d) soapstone construction and star-shaped, stellate plans on a raised platform

Q. 25. In the Odisha school, the tower and the front hall are respectively called the

(a) deul and jagamohan (b) vimana and gopuram (c) shikhara and antarala (d) jagati and kalasha

Q. 26. Rani ki Vav at Patan is

(a) a Chola temple (b) a stepwell of the Solanki period, a UNESCO World Heritage Site (c) a Buddhist vihara (d) a Hoysala shrine

Q. 27. The rathas at Mahabalipuram are

(a) processional chariots of wood (b) the projections of a temple wall (c) monolithic shrines cut from single rocks (d) painted panels

Q. 28. The clearest development in southern temple architecture over time is that

(a) the vimana grew steadily taller than the gopurams (b) sculpture was abandoned (c) temples ceased to have enclosure walls (d) the gopurams grew until they dominated and the vimana became comparatively small

Q. 29. The major early brick temple of the Gupta period is at

(a) Bhitargaon (b) Deogarh (c) Sanchi (d) Aihole

Q. 30. Padmapani is

(a) a Chola bronze (b) a Bodhisattva depicted in the Ajanta paintings (c) a Hoysala sculptor (d) a type of stepwell

5.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard

Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Monument)	List-II (Dynasty)
A. Brihadeeswara temple, Thanjavur	1. Rashtrakuta
B. Kailasa temple, Ellora	2. Pallava
C. Kandariya Mahadeva	3. Chola
D. Shore Temple, Mahabalipuram	4. Chandela

(a) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3

Q. 32. Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

(a) Gopurams are characteristic of Dravida temples (b) The Nagara shikhara is curvilinear in profile (c) The amalaka and kalasha crown a Nagara tower (d) Nagara temples characteristically have large enclosure walls with monumental gateways

Q. 33. Arrange the following in correct chronological order, earliest first: 1. Hampi under Vijayanagara · 2. Dashavatara temple, Deogarh · 3. Brihadeeswara temple, Thanjavur · 4. Rathas at Mahabalipuram

(a) 2-4-3-1 (b) 2-3-4-1 (c) 4-2-3-1 (d) 2-4-1-3

Q. 34. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Cave site)	List-II (Faith)
A. Ajanta	1. Jain
B. Ellora	2. Buddhist only
C. Udayagiri and Khandagiri	3. Shaiva
D. Elephanta	4. Buddhist, Hindu and Jain

(a) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3 (b) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3 (c) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3 (d) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2

Q. 35. Consider the following statements about Ajanta: 1. All its caves are Buddhist. · 2. The paintings were executed on dry prepared plaster rather than as true fresco. · 3. Their subjects include Jataka stories. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 3 only

Q. 36. Which one of the following statements about Ellora is NOT correct?

(a) It has 34 caves (b) Its caves belong to three faiths (c) Cave 16 is the Kailasa temple, carved from a single rock from the top downward (d) All its caves are Buddhist

Q. 37. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (School)	List-II (Material)
A. Gandhara	1. Spotted red sandstone
B. Mathura	2. Soapstone
C. Amaravati	3. Grey schist
D. Hoysala	4. White limestone

(a) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-3 D-4

Q. 38. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Monument)	List-II (State)
A. Sun Temple, Konark	1. Gujarat
B. Khajuraho	2. Odisha
C. Rani ki Vav	3. Karnataka
D. Hampi	4. Madhya Pradesh

(a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3 (b) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3 (c) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3 (d) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3

Q. 39. Which one of the following statements about the Chola bronzes is NOT correct?

(a) They were cast by the lost-wax or cire perdue process (b) The mould is destroyed in casting, so each piece is unique (c) They were carved from chlorite schist (d) Nataraja is their best-known subject

Q. 40. Consider the following statements about the Sun Temple at Konark: 1. It was built by Narasimhadeva I of the Eastern Gangas. · 2. It was conceived as the sun god's chariot, with twelve pairs of carved wheels and seven horses. · 3. It belongs to the Dravida style. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

Q. 41. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Mural site)	List-II (Period and faith)
A. Ajanta	1. Jain, Pandya period
B. Sittanavasal	2. Prehistoric rock paintings
C. Lepakshi	3. Buddhist, Vakataka and Gupta age
D. Bhimbetka	4. Vijayanagara period

(a) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3

Q. 42. Which one of the following statements about Khajuraho is NOT correct?

(a) The temples were built by the Chandelas (b) They are built in the Dravida style with tall gopurams (c) The temples stand on a high jagati and lack enclosure walls (d) Kandariya Mahadeva is the largest of them

6. Answers and Explanations

6.1 Level 1 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
1	a	The innermost sanctum , literally "womb-chamber". (b) is the mandapa, (c) the gopuram, (d) the pradakshina patha - all four terms in one question, which is how the vocabulary is tested
2	b	Dravida. The gopuram is the single most useful term in the chapter, because its presence identifies the style instantly. Nagara temples characteristically have neither enclosure wall nor gateway tower
3	c	Shikhara , in northern usage meaning the whole curving tower. (a) Vimana is the southern tower - and note that shikhara has a second, southern meaning , dealt with in Q4's explanation
4	a	Vimana - pyramidal, in receding storeys. In the south the word shikhara is reserved for the small crowning dome at the vimana's apex , which is why (b) is the trap and why the two traditions' vocabulary must be kept apart
5	b	Nagara. The amalaka is the fluted disc near the top and the kalasha the pot finial above it. Both are northern , as against the southern gopuram, vimana and temple tank
6	c	Barabar , in Bihar, of Ashoka's time and associated with the Ajivikas - not Buddhist , which is what candidates assume of any early cave. The Lomas Rishi doorway imitates a wooden facade
7	d	Karle. (a) Bhaja, (c) Kanheri and (b) Nasik are all genuine early Buddhist sites of the western Deccan, which is what makes them plausible - but Karle is the greatest chaitya
8	a	Buddhism only. (d) three faiths describes ELLORA , and this Ajanta-Ellora distinction is the most frequently asked in the chapter. Ajanta = paintings; Ellora = the Kailasa temple and three faiths
9	d	34. (a) 12 is the Buddhist group, (b) 17 the Hindu group , and 5 the Jain - so the distractors are the components of the correct total, and (c) 29 is roughly AJANTA's count
10	b	Krishna I of the Rashtrakutas , carved from a single rock from the top downward - the greatest monolithic excavation anywhere. (c) Rajasimha built the structural Kailasanatha at Kanchipuram , which is the name-confusion this question exploits
11	c	Elephanta , the colossal three-headed Shiva. (a) Ellora is the near-miss, and the similarity of the names is exactly why the option is offered
12	d	Rajaraja I , about 1010 CE. (a) Rajendra I built Gangaikondacholapuram and (c) Rajaraja II the Airavatesvara at Darasuram - the three together are the UNESCO "Great Living Chola Temples"
13	a	Narasimhadeva I of the Eastern Gangas - the chariot temple with twelve pairs of wheels and seven horses, also called the Black Pagoda
14	b	Chandelas , in the Khajuraho school of Nagara. (a) Solankis built Modhera and Rani ki Vav; (c) Eastern Gangas built Konark; (d) Hoysalas Belur and Halebidu - four dynasties, four regions
15	c	Hoysalas - in soapstone , on stellate plans, UNESCO 2023
16	d	Cholas , tenth to twelfth centuries, cast by lost-wax . (c) The Palas also produced fine bronzes, in eastern India, which is what makes that option plausible

6.2 Level 2 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
17	a	Chalukyas (of Badami and Kalyani) and Hoysalas - the Deccan dynasties, between the northern and southern zones. (b) Cholas and Pandyas are pure Dravida and (c) Chandelas and Solankis pure Nagara

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
18	b	It contains experiments in several styles side by side , which is what "cradle" means here. (a) overstates - Aihole is early but not the oldest temple site - and (c) is simply false
19	c	A main shrine with four subsidiary shrines at the corners of the plinth , five in all. Common in Nagara temples
20	d	12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu, 5 Jain . The Hindu group is the largest , which is the part candidates get wrong by assuming a cave complex must be mostly Buddhist
21	a	Tempera on a DRY prepared ground - fresco-secco. (b) True fresco requires WET plaster so the pigment binds as the lime sets, and Ajanta is not that . This is the one technical point in the mural topic and it is asked
22	b	Jain , of the Pandya period in Tamil Nadu - the principal Jain mural site , and the Jain counterpart to Buddhist Ajanta. The faith is the examinable part
23	c	The wax is melted out and the mould broken to release the casting , so no two pieces can be identical. (a) is precisely what lost-wax cannot do - the process destroys its own mould, which is why the answer follows from the name
24	d	Soapstone and stellate plans on a raised jagati , with lathe-turned pillars and a low broad tower - decoration over height is the Hoysala signature. (a) describes GANDHARA sculpture and (c) the later Nayaka temples
25	a	Deul (rekha-deul) and jagamohan - the Odisha or Kalinga vocabulary, which appears in questions verbatim. Without these two words a candidate cannot answer even a recognition question about Bhubaneswar or Konark
26	b	A stepwell of the Solanki period , at Patan in Gujarat, UNESCO 2014 - and stepwells and tanks are the Maru-Gurjara school's speciality
27	c	Monolithic shrines cut from single rocks. (b) describes the OTHER meaning of "ratha" - the vertical offsets of a temple wall - and both meanings are live in this chapter, which is why the term was flagged in Session 1
28	d	The gopurams grew until they dominated, and the vimana became comparatively small . In Chola work the vimana dominates; by the Nayaka period the gopuram overwhelms it. (a) inverts the actual trend , and it is the standard wrong answer
29	a	Bhitargaon. (b) Deogarh is the classic early Nagara stone shrine and (c) Sanchi temple 17 the flat-roofed earliest stage - three Gupta monuments, three different points in the sequence
30	b	A Bodhisattva in the Ajanta paintings , with Vajrapani its usual companion in a question. Both are among the most reproduced images in Indian art

6.3 Level 3 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
31	c	A-3 Thanjavur-Chola · B-1 Ellora Kailasa-Rashtrakuta · C-4 Kandariya Mahadeva-Chandela · D-2 Shore Temple-Pallava. Knowing only Thanjavur-Chola and Shore Temple-Pallava eliminates every wrong code - the F5.1 partial-knowledge method
32	d	(d) is false and describes DRAVIDA . Nagara temples characteristically have no enclosure wall and no gopuram ; enclosures with monumental gateways are the southern pattern. (a), (b) and (c) are all correct
33	a	2-4-3-1 : Gupta Deogarh (5th-6th century), Pallava Mahabalipuram (7th), Chola Thanjavur (c. 1010), Vijayanagara Hampi (14th-16th). This is the four-stage development of Session 3 in one question
34	b	A-2 Ajanta Buddhist only · B-4 Ellora three faiths · C-1 Udayagiri and Khandagiri Jain · D-3 Elephanta Shaiva. The Ajanta-Ellora pair alone resolves the code

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
35	c	All three are correct. Ajanta is wholly Buddhist , painted in tempera on dry plaster rather than true fresco , and its subjects are largely Jataka stories - the tales of the Buddha's previous births from F5.3, which is why that chapter fed this one
36	d	(d) is false. Ellora is the THREE-FAITH site - 12 Buddhist, 17 Hindu, 5 Jain. The exclusively Buddhist complex is AJANTA , and the two are constantly swapped. (a), (b) and (c) are all true
37	a	A-3 Gandhara grey schist · B-1 Mathura spotted red sandstone · C-4 Amaravati white limestone · D-2 Hoysala soapstone. Material alone answers most questions about the schools , which is why it is the thing to learn
38	b	A-2 Konark-Odisha · B-4 Khajuraho-Madhya Pradesh · C-1 Rani ki Vav-Gujarat · D-3 Hampi-Karnataka. A state-level question is a common way to frame an art item , and it is answerable even by a candidate who knows nothing of the styles
39	c	(c) is false twice over. The Chola bronzes were CAST, not carved , and chlorite schist is soapstone - the HOYSALA material from Q24 and Q37. (a), (b) and (d) are all correct, and (b) follows logically from (a): a process that melts out its pattern and breaks its mould cannot produce duplicates
40	d	1 and 2 only. Statement 3 is false: Konark is Nagara , in the Odisha or Kalinga school, not Dravida - it has a deul , not a vimana with gopurams. Statements 1 and 2 give the builder and the chariot conception
41	a	A-3 Ajanta Buddhist, Vakataka-Gupta · B-1 Sittanavasal Jain, Pandya · C-4 Lepakshi Vijayanagara · D-2 Bhimbetka prehistoric. The four together are the whole mural tradition in one question , from prehistory to the late medieval
42	b	(b) is false and assigns a Nagara temple to the southern style. Khajuraho is Nagara, Khajuraho school - clustered shikharas rising to a central peak, a high jagati , no enclosure wall and no gopurams . (a), (d) and (c) are all correct

7. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F5.5 - ART AND ARCHITECTURE

WHY THIS CHAPTER the **cheapest marks in Module 5** · questions pair **monument-to-dynasty, style-to-feature, material-to-school**, with no reasoning step · **the vocabulary IS the question** · about **fifteen monuments** carry nearly all the marks · **nothing required a date in 2023, so learn the DYNASTY not the year**

TEMPLE VOCABULARY **GARBHAGRIHA** innermost sanctum · **MANDAPA** pillared hall (ardha-, maha-, nata-) · **ANTARALA** vestibule · **PRADAKSHINA PATHA** circumambulatory · **JAGATI** raised plinth · **PANCHAYATANA** main shrine + 4 subsidiary = 5 · **AMALAKA** fluted disc then **KALASHA** pot finial - **both NORTHERN** · **GOPURAM** gateway tower - **SOUTHERN, and it identifies the style instantly** · **RATHA** = wall offsets, BUT at Mahabalipuram = the monolithic shrines

THE SHIKHARA-VIMANA TRAP NORTH: shikhara = the WHOLE curvilinear tower, crowned by amalaka then kalasha · **SOUTH: VIMANA = the pyramidal tower in receding storeys, and "shikhara" means only the small crowning dome at its apex** · so **vimana paired with a northern temple is WRONG**, and a **curvilinear southern tower is WRONG**

THE THREE STYLES NAGARA north · curvilinear **shikhara** · **amalaka + kalasha** · **NO enclosure wall, NO gopuram, usually no tank** · jagati and panchayatana common · Guptas, Chandelas, Eastern Gangas, Solankis · **DRAVIDA** south · pyramidal **vimana** · **enclosure walls with GOPURAMS, large tank, Nandi**, pillared halls · Pallavas, **Cholas**, Pandyas, Nayakas, Vijayanagara · **VESARA** hybrid, Deccan · moderate stocky tower, **decoration over height** · Chalukyas and Hoysalas

THE THREE NAGARA SUB-SCHOOLS ODISHA / KALINGA - tower = **DEUL (rekha-deul)**, hall = **JAGAMOHAN**, nearly vertical then curving sharply at the top - **Lingaraja, Puri, Konark** ·

KHAJURAHO / CENTRAL INDIA (Chandelas) - many **shikharas clustered rising to a central peak**, high **jagati**, no enclosure wall, profuse exterior sculpture - **Kandariya Mahadeva** · **SOLANKI / MARU-GURJARA (Gujarat, Rajasthan)** - interiors, ceilings and **STEPWELLS** are the achievement - **Modhera, Rani ki Vav, Dilwara**

ROCK-CUT - what it means SUBTRACTIVE: cut downward and inward from living rock, **no foundations, no joints, no margin for error** · early work **imitates CARPENTRY** with non-load-bearing stone "beams" - **the more wooden-looking, the earlier**

THE CAVE SITES BARABAR Bihar - **EARLIEST rock-cut caves, MAURYAN, AJIVIKA-associated, Lomas Rishi** wooden-facade doorway · **KARLE - the finest CHAITYA hall in India** · Bhaja, Bedsa, Kanheri, Nasik - recognise only · **AJANTA - ~29-30 caves, BUDDHIST ONLY**, chaityas and viharas, famous for **PAINTINGS**, Satavahana then **Vakataka/Gupta, UNESCO** · **ELLORA - 34 caves: 12 BUDDHIST, 17 HINDU, 5 JAIN, Rashtrakuta, cave 16 = KAILASA temple, monolithic, top-down, by KRISHNA I, Jain caves 30-34 incl. Indra Sabha, UNESCO** · **ELEPHANTA - TRIMURTI / Maheshmurti, Shaiva, UNESCO** · **UDAYAGIRI-KHANDAGIRI** Odisha, **JAIN**, Hathigumpha · **BADAMI** Chalukya · **MAHABALIPURAM** - monolithic **RATHAS**, structural **SHORE TEMPLE, Descent of the Ganges / Arjuna's Penance, UNESCO** - where Indian architecture moves from CUT to BUILT

THE FOUR CAVE CONFUSIONS AJANTA = Buddhist ONLY and PAINTINGS; ELLORA = THREE FAITHS and the KAILASA temple · **KAILASA is at ELLORA (Rashtrakuta, monolithic); KAILASANATHA is at KANCHIPURAM (PALLAVA, structural)** · **TRIMURTI is at ELEPHANTA, not Ellora** · **BARABAR is Mauryan and Ajivika, NOT Buddhist**

THE FOUR TEMPLE STAGES 1 flat-roofed cell (Sanchi 17) → 2 cell with a **shikhara** (Deogarh) → 3 developed temple with **mandapas, tall tower, jagati, sculpture** (Khajuraho, Lingaraja, Brihadeeswara) → 4 the temple as a walled town, **gopurams taller than the vimana** (Hampi, Madurai) · **the single trend: the tower stopped being the tallest thing - Chola vimana dominates, Nayaka gopuram dominates**

DYNASTY TO MONUMENT - the ten that matter GUPTA Nagara begins - **DEOGARH** stone, **BHITARGAON** BRICK, **Sanchi 17** flat-roofed · **CHALUKYA** of **BADAMI** Vesara - **AIHOLE** the "CRADLE" (Durga, Lad Khan), **PATTADAKAL UNESCO** (Virupaksha), Badami caves · **PALLAVA** Dravida invented - **MAHABALIPURAM** rathas and Shore Temple, **KAILASANATHA KANCHIPURAM** under **Rajasimha** · **CHOLA** Dravida at its height - **BRIHADEESWARA THANJAVUR** by **RAJARAJA I** c. **1010**, ~60 m vimana, monolithic capstone and Nandi; **GANGAIKONDACHOLAPURAM** by **RAJENDRA I**; **AIRAVATESVARA DARASURAM** by **Rajaraja II** = the **UNESCO Great Living Chola Temples**; vimana dominates, gopurams modest · **HOYSALA** Vesara - **BELUR, HALEBIDU, SOMNATHPUR, SOAPSTONE, STELLATE** plans, lathe-turned pillars, **UNESCO 2023** · **EASTERN GANGA** (Odisha) - **LINGARAJA, PURI, KONARK** by **NARASIMHADEVA I** as the sun god's **CHARIOT** with **12 PAIRS OF WHEELS** and **7 HORSES**, the **Black Pagoda, UNESCO** · **CHANDELA** - **KHAJURAHO UNESCO, KANDARIYA MAHADEVA** largest · **SOLANKI - MODHERA, RANI KI VAV UNESCO 2014, DILWARA** · **VIJAYANAGARA - HAMPI UNESCO, VITTALA** temple with **STONE CHARIOT** and **MUSICAL PILLARS**, kalyana mandapa and amman shrine · **NAYAKA - MEENAKSHI MADURAI**, hall of a thousand pillars, gopurams overwhelming

THREE SUPERLATIVES, THREE SITES largest monolithic excavation = **KAILASA, ELLORA** · finest chaitya = **KARLE** · tallest Chola vimana = **THANJAVUR**

SCULPTURE - material answers it **GANDHARA** grey schist, Greco-Roman, "Greco-Buddhist" · **MATHURA** spotted red sandstone from Sikri, indigenous, also Jain and Brahmanical · **AMARAVATI** white limestone, narrative · **GUPTA** the classical synthesis - **SARNATH BUDDHA**, Sultanganj bronze · **PALA** black basalt and bronze, **Nalanda**, exported to Nepal, Tibet and South-East Asia · **TERRACOTTA** continuous from the Harappans, later characteristic of **Bengal** · **the sequence: aniconic symbols → first images under the Kushanas in two rival styles → the Gupta ideal that fixed the canon**

CHOLA BRONZES LOST-WAX / CIRE PERDUE - wax model, clay mould, **wax melted out**, metal poured, **mould BROKEN**, so **every piece is UNIQUE** and **duplicates are impossible** · metal **bronze = copper + tin**, the same alloy and method as the **Harappan Dancing Girl** **three thousand years earlier** · **NATARAJA**, Shiva in **ananda tandava** within a ring of flame - **the most recognised image in Indian art** · centres **Thanjavur and Chidambaram** · **it is investment casting - a sacrificial pattern permitting undercuts no two-part mould could release**

MURALS BHIMBETKA prehistoric, **UNESCO** · **AJANTA** the finest - **TEMPERA on DRY plaster = FRESCO-SECCO, NOT true fresco** (true fresco needs WET plaster) - **PADMAPANI** and **Vajrapani, Mahajanaka Jataka**, the **Dying Princess**, subjects from the **Jatakas** · **BAGH** Gupta, Buddhist, close to Ajanta · **SITTANAVASAL** Pandya, **JAIN** - the principal Jain mural site · **BADAMI** among the earliest **HINDU** murals · **LEPAKSHI** Vijayanagara · **THANJAVUR** Chola murals found **beneath Nayaka overpainting**

UNESCO CULTURAL SITES from this field Ajanta · Ellora · Elephanta · Mahabalipuram · Great Living Chola Temples · Pattadakal · Hampi · Khajuraho · Konark · Sanchi · Bodh Gaya · Bhimbetka · Rani ki Vav · Hoysala ensembles · Dholavira · **Maharashtra and Karnataka carry a disproportionate share, and MAHARASHTRA leads on cave architecture**

8. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F5.5 - ART AND ARCHITECTURE

GARBHAGRIHA sanctum · MANDAPA hall · ANTARALA vestibule · JAGATI plinth

PANCHAYATANA = main shrine + 4 subsidiary · AMALAKA + KALASHA = NORTHERN

GOPURAM = SOUTHERN, and it identifies the style instantly

NORTH: shikhara = the WHOLE CURVILINEAR tower · SOUTH: VIMANA pyramidal, shikhara = only its top dome

NAGARA: curvilinear, NO gopuram, NO enclosure, no tank

DRAVIDA: vimana + GOPURAMS + TANK + NANDI + pillared halls

VESARA: hybrid, Deccan, decoration over height - CHALUKYAS + HOYSALAS

ODISHA school: DEUL + JAGAMOHAN · KHAJURAHO: clustered shikharas, high jagati ·

SOLANKI: interiors + STEPWELLS

BARABAR = EARLIEST caves, MAURYAN, AJIVIKA · LOMAS RISHI wooden facade

KARLE = FINEST CHAITYA HALL

AJANTA = BUDDHIST ONLY · ~29-30 caves · PAINTINGS · Vakataka/Gupta

ELLORA = 34 CAVES: 12 BUDDHIST, 17 HINDU, 5 JAIN · RASHTRAKUTA

ELLORA CAVE 16 = KAILASA TEMPLE, MONOLITHIC, TOP-DOWN, KRISHNA I

TRIMURTI = ELEPHANTA (not Ellora) · KAILASANATHA = KANCHIPURAM, PALLAVA, structural

MAHABALIPURAM: monolithic RATHAS + structural SHORE TEMPLE + Descent of the Ganges

STAGES: flat cell (Sanchi 17) → shikhara (Deogarh) → developed (Khajuraho) → walled town (Madurai)

TREND: CHOLA vimana dominates → NAYAKA gopuram dominates

GUPTA: DEOGARH stone · BHITARGAON BRICK · Sanchi 17 flat

CHALUKYA: AIHOLE = "CRADLE" · PATTADAKAL = UNESCO

PALLAVA: Mahabalipuram + KAILASANATHA Kanchipuram (Rajasimha)

CHOLA: BRIHADEESWARA THANJAVUR = RAJARAJA I · GANGAIKONDACHOLAPURAM = RAJENDRA I

AIRAVATESVARA DARASURAM = Rajaraja II · the three = GREAT LIVING CHOLA TEMPLES

HOYSALA: BELUR + Halebidu + SOMNATHPUR · SOAPSTONE · STELLATE · UNESCO 2023

KONARK = NARASIMHADEVA I, EASTERN GANGA · CHARIOT, 12 PAIRS OF WHEELS, 7 HORSES

KHAJURAHO = CHANDELA · KANDARIYA MAHADEVA largest · NAGARA not Dravida

RANI KI VAV (stepwell) + MODHERA = SOLANKI, Gujarat

HAMPI = VIJAYANAGARA · VITTALA temple, STONE CHARIOT, MUSICAL PILLARS

MEENAKSHI MADURAI = NAYAKA · thousand-pillar hall

SUPERLATIVES: monolith = ELLORA KAILASA · chaitya = KARLE · Chola vimana = THANJAVUR

GANDHARA grey schist · MATHURA red spotted sandstone · AMARAVATI white limestone · HOYSALA soapstone

GUPTA sculpture = SARNATH BUDDHA · PALA = black basalt + bronze, Nalanda

CHOLA BRONZES: LOST-WAX (CIRE PERDUE) · mould BROKEN so EVERY PIECE UNIQUE · NATARAJA

AJANTA PAINTING = TEMPERA ON DRY PLASTER = FRESCO-SECCO, NOT TRUE FRESCO

PADMAPANI + VAJRAPANI · subjects = JATAKAS · BAGH = close to Ajanta

SITTANAVASAL = JAIN murals (Pandya) · BADAMI = early HINDU · LEPAKSHI =

VIJAYANAGARA

UNESCO: Ajanta, Ellora, Elephanta, Mahabalipuram, Chola temples, Pattadakal, Hampi, Khajuraho, Konark, Sanchi, Bodhi Gaya, Bhimbetka, Rani ki Vav, Hoysalas, Dholavira -

MAHARASHTRA leads on caves